

Generating response...

In the early days of the internet, our exposure to new websites and thus, newer sources of information was through IRC chat rooms and discussion forums. The forums that we now know and love came in much later. Earlier versions were just simple pages with hundreds of hyperlinks, one-per-line that led to some of the first websites to have ever been created.

As the number of folks getting onto the big WWW grew, slowly, the plain text-like pages made way for richer HTML pages. The conversations grew all the more engaging, and forums became a great place to discover new things. With time came a flood of new users with varied interests and pointed conversations made way for chatter as more and more tangential conversations became the norm. Around this time, forums branched out to allow for more topical discussions and if the topics of interest were much more distinct, then entirely new websites and forums cropped up.

While a lot of the older forums have disappeared as social media age has dawned, making way for smaller communities in the form of “groups”, there’s still a place for anyone to go and discover interesting new things. All the forums active today, make for a massive wealth of information that is constantly updated and verified by millions of humans seeking solutions.

What happens when all these millions of users stop contributing to these forums? It’s not an outlandish thought. What if, I don’t have to visit a forum ever again because an LLM (Large Language Model) such as ChatGPT can provide exactly what I want in a fraction of the time it would have taken me otherwise?

All these LLMs have been trained on billions of pages of human-written content, which is why they’re so on point. If you’re wondering why ChatGPT can provide realistic solutions to why your computer can’t find your printer, it is because the LLM powering the service was trained on hundreds of thousands of HTML pages where real users, facing similarly perplexing printer issues, had put their minds together to obtain an answer. And ChatGPT is smart enough to figure out answers by association. So if a couple of years down the line, you have a similar issue



“Over time, these treasure troves of knowledge will dry up because there will be more human-to-machine conversations rather than human-to-human conversations.”

Mithun Mohandas
Managing Editor



Let me know your thoughts on this column at:
@mithun_mohandas |
mithun@digit.in

under a different OS then ChatGPT will still be able to modify a solution appropriately and produce a valid response.

Over time, these treasure troves will dry up as there’ll be more human-to-machine conversations than human-to-human ones. This has already happened, allegedly. A Google engineer supposedly quit and made public that the company was allegedly training their AI chatbot, Bard, on data from ChatGPT. All conversations will begin and end with a human conversing with an AI chatbot. Slowly but surely, humanity will feed its collective knowledge into making AI all more potent and smarter. And just as surely, these AI chatbots will become the only source of information for us.

Why would there be any need to have any intelligent discourse and institutions like libraries if AI can answer everything? What need do you have of human workers when AI workers can do all of the work quicker and for much cheaper?

Researchers from OpenAI, the company behind ChatGPT and DALL-E, recently came out with a study stating that 19 per cent of the U.S. workforce could see about 50 per cent of their functions impacted and that around 80 per cent would see their roles be impacted by up to 10 per cent. All this, because a service that came out just a few months ago. This is one of the reasons why more than 1800 of the brightest minds have signed an open letter to the AI research companies asking them to pause work on LLMs smarter than ChatGPT 4 for at least six months so that regulations can be put in place to prevent a rapid snowballing effect that could “prove to be dangerous to humanity”.

To show you how much of an impact these generative AI services can have on the labour market, we ran a little experiment. This issue of Digit was mostly generated using these very tools. We’ve made it easy for you to distinguish the articles that were generated using AI in the contents section and on each page featuring AI generated content. This way, you can experience first hand how much of an impact these services can have. Here’s a little exercise, guess how many people were actively involved in the creation of this issue and write to us at editor@digit.in. The winner gets something special from us. **1**